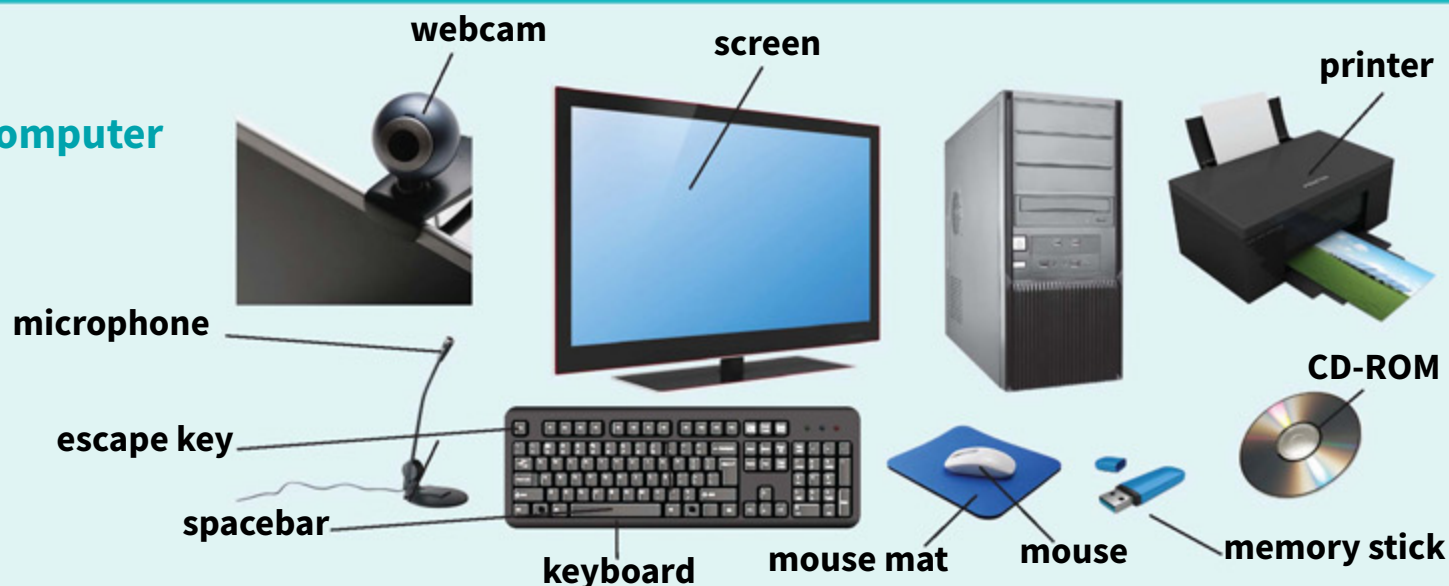


A

The computer



B

Using a computer

After you have **switched on** [turned on] your computer, you may need to **log in/on** (*opp* **log out/off**) with your **username** and **enter** your **password** [put a special word into the computer that only you know]. If you then **double-click** on an **icon** [a small picture on the screen], you can open an **application** [email, Internet browser, etc.].

Computers can **store** [keep] large amounts of information, but when you're working it is important to **back up** the **files** you are working on [make an extra copy of the files; *syn* **make a backup**], so you don't lose the files if something goes wrong.



open a new
document



open an
existing
document



save the
data in this
document



print



cut



copy



paste

To **create** [make or start] a new document, select new from the **File menu**.

You can **copy** and **paste** information from one file into another.

If you save the document, you can **print it out** later (OR you can get a **hard copy** / a **printout** later). It is also important to save the document in case the computer **crashes** [suddenly stops working]. Press the Escape key to **exit** [stop using an application].

C

FAQs* about computers

example question	explanation
• Do you have a PC or a laptop ?	PC is short for personal computer; a laptop is a small computer that you can carry around.
• What hard drive do you have?	the part inside the computer that stores large amounts of information (also hard disk)
• What operating system are you using?	computer software, e.g. Windows or Mac OS, that controls how the computer works
• Have you installed any new software ?	put new programs onto your computer
• What software applications are you running ?	What software applications are you using?
• Do you have anti-virus software ?	A virus is a program put on a computer to destroy or steal the information on it. Anti-virus software is a program to stop a virus entering your computer.

*frequently asked questions